R FOR DATA ANALYSIS · R BASICS · LESSON 3

03 Variables and your first vector

Save values with the assignment arrow, then group them together in a vector.

BY THE END OF THIS SECTION YOU WILL BE ABLE TO

- Save a value with the arrow <-
- Find your variables in the Environment pane
- Combine values into a vector with c()

The R code in this lesson

```
# Assign values with <-
name <- "Ahmad"
age <- 30
location <- "USA"

# Print them
name
age
location

# A vector lists related values with c()
demographic <- c(name, age, location)
demographic
```

What you will hear (times count from the end of the intro)

Intro Now we will teach R to remember things. In this lesson, you will learn to save values in variables with the assignment arrow, find them in the Environment pane, and group related values together in a vector. Let's go gently, one line at a time.

0:00 I add a note: assigning a variable. For this, we use the assignment operator. It is a small arrow: a less than sign, and a dash.

0:12 First line: name, arrow, and a name in quotes. Run it. Look at the Environment pane on the right. A new variable, name, has appeared. R remembers it now.

0:22 Next, age, arrow, thirty. And location, arrow, USA.

0:30 Oh, look at the console: object USA not found. I forgot the quotation marks. Without quotes, R looks for a variable called USA. So I add the quotes, run it again, and now it works.

0:50 To see a value, just type the variable name and run it. Name gives the name. Age gives thirty. Location gives USA.

1:20 Now, a new idea: the vector. A vector keeps related values together in one place. We make it with the letter c and brackets. The c stands for combine.

1:58 I write: demographic, arrow, c, and inside the brackets, name, age, and location, separated by commas.

2:30 Run it, and in the Environment pane you see demographic, with three values. R even tells us it is character, because it holds text.

2:50 One thing to notice: thirty now appears in quotes. A vector keeps one type, so R turned the number into text to match. Good to remember! You are doing really well.